Local SEO Masterclass

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Ranking a Local Google ...

Introduction to Local SEO

NAP Consistency + Map Emb...

Getting ONLY 5 Star Reviews f...

Getting a Google My Busines...

GMB Location + Direction Ma...

Rank and Rent (Organic S...

Introduction to Rank and Rents

Setting up a Rank and Rent

Ranking your Rank and Rent

Pricing your Rank and Rent

Pitching Rank and Rents

Local SEO for Beginners (...

Module 1: Introduction to Loc...

Module 2: Setting Up Your Go...

Module 6: Local Business Schema Markup



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Overview: In this module, we dive into **Schema markup** for local businesses. Schema is a structured data vocabulary (from Schema.org) that you can add to your website's code to give search engines extra information in a standardized format. By implementing **LocalBusiness schema**, you can explicitly provide Google details like your business name, address, phone, hours, geo-coordinates, reviews, etc., which can lead to rich results (like stars or an address in your search snippet). While not directly a ranking factor, schema can improve click-through rates and ensure Google has accurate info about your business. Many small businesses neglect this, so adding schema is a great way to outperform competitors in professionalism. We'll cover step-by-step how to generate and install schema markup

17

schema-generator/

Lessons:

1. **What is Schema and Why Use It?** – We explain in simple terms that schema markup is like a vocabulary for search

Module 3: Expanding Presenc…

Module 4: Local Keyword Res…

Module 5: On-Page SEO for Y…

Module 6: Local Business Sch…

Module 7: Key Local SEO Ran…

Module 8: Building Citations

Module 9: Advanced Google …

Module 10: Online Reviews & …

Module 11: Local Link Buildin…

Module 12: Setting Up Analyti…

Module 13: Conducting a Loc…

Module 14: Competitor SEO A…

Module 15: Tracking and Rep…

Module 16: Bringing It All Tog…

engines. It doesn't change what visitors see on your site; it's code that only search engines read. For local SEO, using the **LocalBusiness** schema type (and its subtypes, e.g., Restaurant, Plumber, DentalClinic, etc.) allows you to feed Google important details about the business in a structured way. This can enhance your search listings – for example, if you markup reviews, Google might display star ratings in your result snippet. We emphasize that only a minority of local businesses use schema, so doing this can give you an edge by making your listing stand out.

2. **Types of Local Schema Markup** – We introduce common schema properties for local businesses: **Name**, **Address**, **Telephone**, **OpeningHours**, **GeoCoordinates**, **Website**, **Logo**, **PriceRange**, and **aggregateRating** (if you have reviews). If the business has specific info like a menu (for restaurants) or service list, there are schema types for those too. We'll list out a "checklist" of information you should prepare for schema implementation: official business name, full address, phone, business type, hours of operation, etc. This is often the same info you entered in Google Business Profile – schema reinforces that on your site in a structured way.

3. **Generating Schema Markup Easily** – You don't have to write JSON-LD code from scratch. We demonstrate user-friendly methods: one is using **Google's Structured Data Markup Helper** – you can input your page and tag the content, and it will generate code for you. Another method is using a schema generator tool or a WordPress plugin (if your site is on WordPress, plugins like "Schema – All In One Rich Snippets" can simplify the process). We'll walk through an example using Google's tool: selecting the data type (Local Business, Article, etc.), tagging elements on the page (like highlighting the business name, address, etc.), and letting the tool output JSON-LD code.



schema code (likely in JSON-LD format), add it to your website's HTML. We advise adding it in the `<head>` section or at the bottom of the `<body>` of your contact page or homepage (either is fine for JSON-LD). If using a CMS, paste it into a header script section or a plugin field. After adding, use Google's **Rich Results Test** or **Schema Markup**

Validator to check if it's recognized without errors. We also mention that after implementing, you likely won't *instantly* see changes – but Google may start showing richer info within a few weeks. It's also good to monitor Search Console for any structured data errors.

Implementation Steps:

- **Gather Business Details:** Write down all the key info about the business (many of these you have already, but ensure it's up-to-date): business name, address, phone, website URL, business type/category, hours, and any other relevant details (like price range "$$", or latitude/longitude if you want to specify location coordinates). If the business has accumulated Google reviews or other ratings you can legally include, note the average rating and count (for aggregateRating schema).
- **Choose a Schema Tool:** Navigate to **Google's Structured Data Markup Helper** (just search for it). Select the "Local Businesses" schema (or a subtype if appropriate) and enter the URL of your site's contact page (or homepage) to start tagging. Alternatively, use a free online schema generator for Local Business – these typically have a form where you input the info from step 1 and it outputs JSON-LD code.
- **Create the Schema Markup:** Using the tool, tag the elements on your page: highlight the business name on the page and assign it as the Name, highlight the address text and assign Address components, etc. Continue until you've marked up all the key items (Google's tool will list suggestions like "Address, Phone, Hours, Image" to fill in). Once done, click to **generate the HTML** or JSON. Copy the generated **JSON-LD script** – it will look like a block of code containing your info in a structured format.
- **Add Schema to Site:** Edit your website to include the



HTML directly, paste the `<script type="application/ld+json"> ... </script>` code into the `<head>` section of the page (or you can place it just before the closing `</body>` tag). This script is not visible to users

on the page, but search engines will read it. Save and publish the changes.

- **Test the Markup:** Immediately test your URL using the **Rich Results Test** (Google it, and input your page URL). This will show if Google detects the Local Business schema and if there are any errors. Fix any errors (the test will point them out, e.g., maybe a required field was missing). Once it's error-free, you're set. Over time, watch for enhanced listings – for example, if you marked up reviews, you might see star ratings appear in Google results for your site, which can boost click-through.

Milestone: *By the end of Module 6, you will have implemented LocalBusiness schema markup on the website.* This means you've given search engines a richer understanding of the business – who you are, where you are, what you offer – in a structured format. You might not see an immediate ranking jump from schema, but you've set the stage for potential rich snippets (address info, stars from reviews, etc.) which can **significantly improve your visibility and click-through rate**. This level of detail and professionalism can set your SEO agency apart, as you provide clients with a technical enhancement many competitors overlook.